



- SAT score of ideally above 1530.
- Pre-professionalism (prior exposure to the field they are applying with through internships, apprenticeship etc.)
- Intelligent trauma dumping (let most of the trauma be subtly tied to your major)
- Doesn't care much for the African/traditional card unless it's aimed at addressing a problem in the intended major field.
- Essays should demonstrate awareness of the world around them e.g current affairs in whatever field and should prey on that. (Let them paint themselves as a global citizen rather than just an African with a big dream.)
- Have a recommendation from the company/person that exposed them to their field of interest via internships etc.
- Quirkiness and humor in the essays. (MIT tries to portray the image that it isn't as serious as everyone thinks, play into this.)
- Conciseness and easy relatability in the why major.
- In as much as quirkiness is appreciated, show them some 'seriousness' in a few essays (preferably in the 'Significant challenge' or 'Describe Your World essay').
- Easy, relatable engagement with your community. Big projects are good, just make sure the 'personal & relational touch' is present.
- Activities should be overwhelmingly related to the field/major of choice in different ways (big STEM Projects and small community service ones). However, diversity of activities is also appreciated (you can include those that add to your brand).
- Ideally brand yourself in 3 ways (STEM person, something artistic/sporty and trauma victim).
- Community service and teamwork **MUST** always be shown in your application.
- In the section for activities where there is no description allowance, ensure you explain the name and all that you did within the title itself!
- Conciseness always!
- Have the pre-exposure to the field of your interest in the job-listing section.
- Mental strength should be greatly demonstrated. MIT is not an easy school to stay in. (Show that the challenges you've gone through have prepared you well for whatever struggle and an academic struggle is nowhere near what you've been through.)
- Demonstrate interest by attending webinars.